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Your ref.: **20881549.8 1001 / 3893188 PCT/KR2020012685**
Our ref.: **EUR1637WEP**

Re: European Patent Application No. 2082754938 filed on 31.09.2020 and relating to a: "RADON MANAGEMENT SYSTEM USING RADON DETECTOR" in the name of Ftlab Co., Ltd.

In Response to the Official Communication dated 09.03.2022 (Communication pursuant to Rule 70(2) and 70a(2) EPC)

Herewith are submitted:

new claims 1 to 17 to replace all claims as presently on file;

new description pages 1-44 to replace description pages 1-44 as presently on file.

For the sake of convenience, fair and marked up copies of new claims 1 to 17 are enclosed herewith.

It is requested that further examination of the present application be based on the new application documents identified above, along with those application documents as presently on file which are not to be replaced by same.

Present claim 1 has been amended so that the resulting new claim 1 specifies that the random management system includes a “a plurality of radon detectors” and to further include the subject matter of present claims 2 and 7.

Support for the above identified features now recited in claim 1 is given, by way of example, by present claims 1, 2 and 7 in combination.

New claims 2 to 17 correspond to present claims 3 to 6 and 8 to 19, respectively, with the only exceptions being that in new claim 2 to 17 the reference to previous claims has been readapted to the new wording of same.

It results therefore from the above that new claims 1 to 17 do not introduce subject matter extending beyond the content of the application as originally filed and meet therefore the requirements of Art. 123(2) EPC.

Art. 54 and 56 EPC

The examiner has already recognized that the subject matter of present claim 7 meets the requirements of Article 54 EPC as to novelty of the subject matter claimed therein; the subject matter of present claim 7 is now claimed in new claim 1.

New claim 1 therefore recites novel subject matter within the meaning of Article 54 EPC and further comments in this respect appear to be dispensable, at present.

As to inventive step of the subject matter claimed in new claim 1 the following is pointed out.

The Examiner considers that, as to the subject matter of present claim 1, document D1 has to be regarded as disclosing the most relevant prior art; the Applicant agrees with the Examiner in this respect.

However, as to the subject matter of new claim 1 the attention of the Examiner is kindly drawn to the following.

According to new claim 1, the radon detection system includes a plurality of radon detectors (100-1 to 100-N) installed in a specific space indoors or outdoors. The system of D1 discloses a radon detector 300, a soil measurement module 100 and an environment measurement module 200 (not a plurality of radon detector).

Moreover, and still according to new claim 1, "the average value of the collected alpha particle concentration value" is not only stored in a database "DB" but also in a "separate storage device": when the calculated amount of change in the alpha particle concentration value is greater than a preset reference amount of change (with respect to the average value stored in the DB), the user is notified to intervene for reducing alpha particle concentration value. Moreover, to determine whether or not the user has performed the actions to reduce the alpha particle concertation, the system is configured to check if the alpha particle concentration value transmitted in real time from each radon detector is less than the average value of the alpha particle concentration values previously stored in the storage device (not the one which is stored in the DB).

The effect of the features mentioned above is that the user intervention (reducing the concentration of alpha particle) is detected even when a new notification has to be sent to the user (since intervention is checked with respect to the previously stored average value of alpha particles whereas notification is send considering the new average value). This may happen, for instance, if the user has correctly applied the actions required, meaning that his intervention was effective, but not resolutive, since the indoor space is still affected by radon.

The technical problem, starting from D1 as the closest prion art, may be regarded as how to detect the intervention of the user.

D1 (par. 14) discloses that the system generates a standard graph of the annual radon average concentration based on radon concentration data measured for predetermined period in the indoor spaces. The prediction management server 500 compares the estimated radon value (which is a function of the average concentration) with the actual radon measurement (the one sensed by sensors) to notify the administrator of terminal 20 (par. 143). D1 can store video and sound (par. 167). However, the user action is not determined, at least not as specified in new claim 1.

The above identified distinguishing features of the subject matter of new claim 1 belong to the contribution of the subject matter and are neither anticipated nor rendered obvious by any of the available prior art documents, nether by D2.

It has therefore to be recognized, in view of the above, that even if one would have considered implementing into the system for detecting radon the teachings to be retrieved from D2, he would not have arrived, in doing so, at the subject matter of new claim 1.

The subject matter of new claim 1 may therefore not be regarded as being obvious to those skilled in the art in view of the available prior art but has rather to be regarded as involving an inventive step within the meaning of Art. 56 EPC.

New claims 1 to 17 meet therefore the requirements of Art. 52 EPC.

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Prior art documents D1 to D2 have been identified in the description in compliance with Rule 42(1)(b) EPC.

The features in new claims 1 to 17 are now duly identified by reference numerals to increase intelligibility in compliance with to Rule 43(7) EPC.

New claim 1 is drafted in two-part form in compliance with to Rule 43(1) EPC.

The description has been brought into conformity with the new claims.

Since the application documents now meet the requirements of the EPC, in particular since new claims 1 to 17 meet the requirements of Articles 52 and 123(2) EPC, the issue of a Communication under Rule 71(3) is requested as the next step of the proceedings; however, should the Examiner still regard new claims 1 to 17 as being not allowable, an interview and, as an utmost precaution only, Oral Proceedings via

video conferencing (Examination Guideline E.II.11) using IP technology are requested before any decision being taken to reject the present application. In case the request for Oral Proceedings via video conferencing is not allowed, the applicant secondarily requests Oral Proceedings without video conferencing.

M. ZARDI & CO. SA

Stefano Sinigaglia
(Representative)

Encl.: new amended claims 1 to 17 (fair and marked up copies)
new description pages 1-44 (fair and marked up copies)